

Sales Reimbursement System

User Handbook

A complete, role-by-role guide to submitting, approving, disbursing, and reporting on expense reimbursements, cash advances, and liquidations.

For Requestors • Approvers • Custodians • Finance • Admins

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About this handbook

This handbook explains how to use the Sales Reimbursement System day to day. It is organised by role — jump to the section that matches how you use the app, or read the shared chapters (Signing in, Getting around, Notifications & settings) that apply to everyone.

The system manages four kinds of money requests end to end: everyday **reimbursements**, **transport reimbursements**, **cash advances** taken before spending, and **liquidations** that settle an advance against real receipts. Every request moves through a controlled lifecycle with a clear owner at each step.

About the current version. This is a high-fidelity prototype. Core workflows are fully functional, but a few production pieces are still being finished: sign-in uses an account picker instead of a company password (Microsoft sign-in is planned), and outbound email / Teams messages are recorded in an in-app outbox rather than delivered externally. Where a feature behaves this way, the handbook says so.

Conventions used

- **Bold** names in the text (for example **Submit Claim**) are buttons or sidebar items you click.
- Amounts are in Philippine Pesos (PHP); the app displays the peso sign throughout.
- “Your approver” means the manager the org chart assigns to you; you never approve your own request.

Key concepts

The five roles

Your role decides which screens you see and what you can do. One person has one role in the app.

Role	What they do
Requestor	Submits reimbursements, transport reimbursements, cash advances, and liquidations; tracks them; confirms payout with a release code.
Approver	Everything a Requestor can do, plus reviews and approves / returns / rejects requests routed to them, and confirms review meetings.
Custodian	Disburses approved money: generates release codes, sets the payment method, marks items ready to claim, and records completed payouts and refunds.
Finance	Company-wide, view-only oversight from approval onward: records, receipts, completed transactions, and analytics. Cannot create or change anything.
Admin	Configures the system: user accounts and the org chart, company directory, catalogs and custom fields, historical import, reporting, and the audit trail.

The four request types

Type	When you use it	Needs a meeting?
Reimbursement	You already spent your own money and want it back.	Yes — Minutes of Meeting
Transport Reimbursement	A reimbursement specifically for travel/transport costs.	Yes
Cash Advance	You need funds up front, before spending.	No
Liquidation	You settle a cash advance against your actual receipts.	No (links to the advance)

The request lifecycle

Every request has a **status** that tells you exactly where it is and who it is waiting on. The typical happy path for a reimbursement is:

Draft → Pending Approval → Approved → Processing → Ready for Claim → Completed.
Cash advances end at **Released** and are later settled by a liquidation, which moves through **Reviewed** to **Closed**.

A request can also be **Returned for Revision** (sent back to you to fix) or **Rejected** (declined outright). The full list of statuses and what each one means is in the **Status reference** chapter near the end.

Signing in

Open the app and you will see a list of accounts grouped by role. Click your name to sign in — no password is required in this version. Each browser tab keeps its own sign-in, so a presenter can open one tab per role side by side against the same data.

To switch accounts, click **Sign out** in the top-right corner of any page; that returns you to the account list.

Coming later. Sign-in will move to your Microsoft work account (Entra ID). When that is in place, the account picker disappears and your role comes from your company identity.

Getting around

The top bar

- **Search** — find claims, IDs, clients, and purposes from any page.
- **Bell** — your notifications, with a red badge counting unread items.
- **Help** — opens Support.
- **Your name, role, and photo** — on the far right, with **Sign out** beside it.

The sidebar

The left sidebar shows only what your role needs. Some items carry a live count badge (pending approvals, items in your queue, unread notifications). Here is what each role sees:

Role	Sidebar items
Requestor	Dashboard • My Requests • Payouts • Expenses & Receipts • Minutes & Agreements • Calendar • Notifications • Support • Settings
Approver	The Requestor items, plus Approvals (with a pending-count badge).
Custodian	Dashboard • Processing Queue • Ready to Claim • Transaction History • Analytics • Notifications • Support • Settings
Finance	Dashboard • Approved Records • Financial Receipts • Paid & Completed • Analytics • Notifications • Support • Settings
Admin	Dashboard • User Accounts • Company Directory • Historical Import • Admin Reporting • System Activity • Notifications • Support • Settings

For Requestors

As a Requestor you create money requests and see them through to payout.

Submitting a reimbursement

Click **Submit Claim**, then **Reimbursement**. The wizard has four steps:

1. **Minutes of Meeting** — who you met (pick from the company directory or type a new contact), the purpose, location, one or more contact persons each with a designation, one or more client-copy email recipients, and a discussion summary. You can fill this in or upload an existing MoM document. Depending on your admin's configuration, extra fields (account type, category, department) may appear.
2. **Details & Items** — your expense line items: date, category, vendor, payment method, amount, and a receipt / OR photo or PDF for each. Every line needs a receipt before you can submit.
3. **Schedule Review** — propose a date and time for a short review meeting with your approver. It is sent to them to confirm.
4. **Review & Submit** — a summary of everything above. Check it, then **Submit**.

Click **Save Draft** at any point to finish later. Drafts appear in **My Requests** with a **Draft** status and are not visible to your approver yet. Once submitted, the request moves to **Pending Approval** and your approver is notified.

A **transport reimbursement** works exactly the same way — choose it instead of Reimbursement when the costs are travel/transport.

Working with Minutes & Agreements

The **Minutes & Agreements** area holds both Minutes of Meeting (MoM) and Letter of Agreement (LOA) records. You can:

- Add multiple client contact people, each with their own designation.
- Add multiple client email recipients for the client copy.
- Preview and export separate **internal** and **client** copies — the client copy omits internal-only fields such as Type of Account.
- Edit a saved record at any time, even after it is completed, so a client-requested correction can be recorded.
- Preview the exact client-facing document and export it as PDF or Word.

Prototype limitation. **Send to client** records an outbox event and marks the record completed; it does not yet deliver a real email or attach the PDF — that is waiting on the email/Teams integration.

Requesting a cash advance

Submit Claim → **Cash Advance**. Just an amount and a purpose — no meeting or expense lines, since you have not spent anything yet. After your approver approves it and the custodian releases the funds, its status becomes **Released**: the money is with you and a liquidation is expected once you have spent it.

Liquidating a cash advance

Submit Claim → **Liquidation**. Pick the advance you are settling, then add your actual expense line items (date, category, vendor, amount, receipt for each). The system computes the difference automatically:

Outcome	Meaning	What happens next
Settled	You spent exactly what was advanced.	Nothing further owed.
Refund Due	You spent less than advanced.	You owe the difference back; the custodian collects it.
Reimbursement Due	You spent more than advanced.	A follow-up reimbursement is raised automatically for the difference.

Tracking your requests

My Requests lists everything you have submitted — reimbursements, advances, and liquidations together — with search and a status filter. Click any row for the full detail page, including its complete status history and (for reimbursements) the linked Minutes of Meeting.

Getting paid

When a request reaches **Ready for Claim**, the custodian has released it and issued a **release code**. Go to **Payouts**, find the request, click **Enter Code to Claim**, type the code the custodian gave you, and confirm.

This is the one step only **you** can do. It is an anti-fraud check that proves the payout actually reached you — not just that the custodian says it did. The request is not **Completed** until you enter the code.

If a request is returned to you

If an approver sends a reimbursement back (status **Returned for Revision**), open it from **My Requests** and click **Revise & Resubmit**. Fix whatever the approver flagged — their comment is shown on the request — then resubmit; it goes straight back into their queue.

Scheduling your review meeting

If your approver declines the review-meeting time you proposed, you will see it under **Calendar** marked “Reschedule requested,” with their reason. Open it and propose a new date and time.

For Approvers

You get everything a Requestor gets (you submit your own expenses too) plus an **Approvals** queue.

Reviewing a request

Approvals shows everything routed to you — your direct reports' reimbursements, cash advances, and liquidations. Filter by All / High Priority / Cash Advances, or open any row for the full detail (line items, receipts, the linked MoM). From there:

Action	Effect	Requires a comment?
Approve	Moves the request on to processing / release.	No
Return	Sends a reimbursement back to the requestor to fix and resubmit.	Yes
Reject	Declines the request outright; it ends here.	Yes

You will also be asked to **confirm or decline** the review meeting the requestor proposed — that happens from **Calendar**, not the approval queue.

You can never approve your own request, even if you have approval authority. This is enforced by the system, not just hidden in the UI.

Handling a stale approval

Occasionally a “**Stale Approvals Detected**” banner appears at the top of your queue. It means one of your direct reports' requests still needs your review, but that person's manager has since changed (an org-chart update). The system deliberately leaves the request with you rather than moving it silently. You can keep reviewing it yourself, or click **Transfer** to hand it to the suggested new approver.

Delegating your approvals

Going on leave? Go to **Settings** → **Delegation** and request coverage: pick another approver and a date range. Once they accept, any request that would route to you routes to them instead for that window. You will see delegations you requested and delegations you are covering for others in the same tab, with Accept / Decline buttons.

Reviewing team receipts

In **Expenses & Receipts**, Approvers can review eligible team receipts using the search, amount, category, status, date, and quick-view filters. Results can also be grouped **By Team Member** or **By Client** to make reconciliation

and follow-up easier.

For Custodians

You handle disbursement — releasing approved money and confirming refunds.

Processing an approved request

Processing Queue lists every request an approver has cleared. Filter by All / In Audit / Cash Advances / Liquidations. For each one:

1. **Generate a Claim Code** (release code) — a short code you give the requestor separately (in person, by chat, however your office does it).
2. Pick the **payment method** (Cash, GCash, Bank Transfer, or Check — your admin controls the list) and mark it **Ready for Claim**.

The requestor then confirms receipt with that code (see **Getting paid**) — that is what completes the request, not a custodian action. **Ready to Claim** is your view of everything still waiting on the requestor's confirmation.

Reimbursements are paid in **Cash**; the other payment methods apply to cash advances. **Transaction History** shows every completed payout with its date, method, and reference; **Analytics** gives you a dashboard of your queue's shape and throughput.

Collecting a liquidation refund

When a liquidation comes through as **Refund Due**, it lands in your queue the same way — review it, collect the difference from the requestor, then mark it closed.

For Finance

Finance is a **view-only** role with company-wide visibility from approval onward. Drafts, submitted-but-unapproved requests, pending approvals, pre-Finance rejections, and unreviewed liquidations are intentionally excluded.

Screen	What it gives you
Approved Records	Filter claims, advances, and liquidations by type, status, client, location, or submitted date.
Financial Receipts	Receipt totals plus requestor, category, and date filters; group by client or requestor.
Paid & Completed	Finalised transaction activity.
Analytics	Expenditure, department, client, category, and workflow views.

Finance users cannot create or edit requests, approve or return them, process disbursements, generate release codes, or change configuration. Personal Minutes & Agreements remain private unless linked to a submitted claim.

For Admins

Admin tools configure the whole system. The main sidebar gives you:

Screen	What you do there
User Accounts	Manage every account — role, department, manager (org chart), employment status, and (for Approvers) whether they can approve reimbursements. Changing someone's manager triggers the stale-approval handling described for Approvers.
Company Directory	The client/company list requestors pick from when filling a MoM, with address and contact info that auto-fills meeting details.

Screen	What you do there
Historical Import	Prototype CSV import for past claims (see the note below).
Admin Reporting	Charts and CSV export of claims across the whole organisation.
System Activity	Two tabs: the searchable Audit Log of workflow and configuration events, and the mock email / Teams outbox .

Configuration inside Settings

As an Admin you also maintain, from **Settings**:

- **Field Definitions** — the extra fields shown on the MoM and claim forms: label, input type, required/optional, which claim types they apply to, and whether they draw options from a Master Data catalog.
- **Master Data catalogs** — the shared lists (Departments, Cost Centers, Business Units, Branches, Project Codes, Vendors). Anything marked inactive stops appearing as a choice on new forms but stays on old records.

Stale-approver escalation runs automatically every hour. The Admin dashboard's **Run Fallback Check** button is a manual trigger — handy for a demo — that escalates any request stuck too long in a stale-approver state without a transfer.

Historical Import is a prototype. It reports success after adding records to process memory; imported batches are not yet durable across a restart. Do not use it for a real migration until the transactional backend is finished.

Everyone: notifications, support & settings

- **Notifications** — email / Teams events addressed to you in the current session. Click the bell for a quick preview, or open the full page. (Delivery is mocked in this version.)
- **Support** — open a ticket if something is wrong. Set a priority, link it to a specific claim if relevant, and reply in the thread. Admins see and answer everyone's tickets; you see only your own.
- **Settings** — your read-only directory profile, notification preferences, delegation (Approvers only), and a placeholder for future account security. Notification preferences persist and control whether a category creates a notification at all.
- **Expenses & Receipts** — every receipt you are authorised to view, with search, quick views, and category / status / date / amount filters. Approvers also get team/client grouping.
- **Calendar** — your upcoming review meetings, in a month view.

Status reference

Every request carries one of these statuses. “Waiting on” tells you who has to act next.

Status	Meaning	Waiting on
Draft	Saved but not submitted; only you can see it.	Requestor
Submitted	Submitted and entering the workflow.	System
Review Meeting Scheduled	A review meeting has been proposed with the approver.	Approver
Pending Approval	In the approver's queue for review.	Approver
Approved	Approved; heading to the custodian for release.	Custodian
Processing	Custodian is preparing the disbursement.	Custodian
Ready for Claim	Released with a code; awaiting your confirmation.	Requestor
Completed	You entered the code; the payout is confirmed and closed.	— (done)
Returned for Revision	Sent back to you to fix and resubmit.	Requestor

Status	Meaning	Waiting on
Rejected	Declined outright; the request ends here.	— (ended)
Released	Cash advance funds are with the requestor.	Requestor (to liquidate)
Liquidated	A liquidation has been filed against an advance.	Custodian / Finance
Reviewed	The liquidation has been reviewed.	Custodian
Closed	Fully settled and closed.	— (done)

Who can do what

A quick reference of the main capabilities by role. “View” means read-only access.

Capability	Req	Appr	Cust	Fin	Admin
Submit requests	✓	✓	—	—	—
Approve / return / reject	—	✓	—	—	—
Confirm review meeting	—	✓	—	—	—
Delegate approvals	—	✓	—	—	—
Generate release code	—	—	✓	—	—
Set payment method / release	—	—	✓	—	—
Confirm payout (enter code)	✓	✓	—	—	—
Company-wide records	—	—	View	View	View
Analytics dashboards	—	—	✓	✓	✓
Manage users / org chart	—	—	—	—	✓
Configure fields / catalogs	—	—	—	—	✓
View audit log	—	—	—	—	✓

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Reimbursement	A request to get back money you already spent.
Cash advance	Money given to you up front, before you spend it.
Liquidation	Settling a cash advance against your actual receipts.
MoM / LOA	Minutes of Meeting / Letter of Agreement — the meeting record that anchors a reimbursement.
Release code / Claim code	A short code the custodian issues that the requestor enters to confirm a payout.
Internal vs client copy	Two versions of a MoM export; the client copy omits internal-only fields (e.g. Type of Account).
Delegation	Temporarily routing your approvals to another approver while you are away.
Stale approval	A pending request whose owner's manager changed after it was submitted; it stays with the original approver until transferred.

Term	Meaning
Custodian	The person who releases approved funds and records payouts and refunds.
Outbox	The in-app record of email / Teams messages (mocked in this version).

FAQ

Why can't I approve my own claim?

By design — a requestor can never approve their own expense, even with approval authority. The system enforces it.

The custodian says they released my payment, but it isn't marked complete.

That's expected. A payout isn't complete until **you** enter the release code on the **Payouts** page. Ask your custodian for the code if you don't have it.

My claim's approver looks out of date — is that a bug?

Not necessarily. If your manager changed recently, the claim intentionally stays with your previous approver until they (or an admin) transfer it. See **Handling a stale approval**.

How do I export a Minutes of Meeting or claim as a file?

Open the record and use its export menu to produce a PDF or Word document. On a MoM you can choose the internal copy or the client copy. (A browser **Print** option is also available for a quick paper copy.)

Amounts show as pesos — is that right?

Yes. The system is modelled entirely in Philippine Pesos (PHP).

Why didn't my client actually receive the emailed minutes?

In this version, **Send to client** records an outbox event but does not deliver a real email yet — that's waiting on the email/Teams integration.